

Creative Production Standards

Cymbal Voyages Brand Studio · Agency onboarding packet · Last updated September 2026

This page fixes the vocabulary of our creative so that a brief, an asset and a performance report all describe the same thing. Imagery styles, offer framings and calls to action come from the closed sets below. A brief that needs something outside them explains why in its Creative direction section and gets sign-off before production.

Imagery styles

Style	What it shows	Use it for	Evidence
Beach couple	Two people at the water's edge or on a terrace, mid-conversation, no posing. Warm light, real skin, no sunset silhouettes.	Lapsed and active Compass members, warm escapes. The lead style for every win-back campaign.	Converted best in CMP-003 (14.9 percent of its cell).
Family pool	A family in and around a resort pool, children swimming, adults nearby.	Holiday-season pushes across all customers; family packages.	Outperformed everything else in the November to December window of CMP-004.
Resort aerial	The property and its coastline from above. No people visible.	Prospecting and category collections. Never the lead for lapsed members.	Underperformed beach couple by a wide margin in CMP-003.
City skyline	A recognizable skyline or street scene of the named city, at street level or from a rooftop, with people in it.	Urban explorers and city breaks.	Best-performing style in CMP-006 city placements and in CMP-012 (1.9 percent click-through against 1.1 for the alternative).
Adventure	Real itinerary footage or stills: a trail, a boat, a market, a mountain. Movement, weather, scale.	Adventure seekers, ski (the mountain, not the lodge), and prospecting video.	Carried CMP-008 to our best paid-social engagement; mountain imagery beat lodge imagery in CMP-005.

Every image must show the place it is captioned as, be licensed for the channels and dates of use, and carry a release for any identifiable person. See the legal claims list.

Offer framings

Framing	Allowed for	Not allowed for	Notes
Percent off	Prospects and non-member customers, on a defined set of departures.	Cymbal Compass members at any tier; sitewide use.	CMP-006 converted members at 0.7 percent and cheapened the brand for our best customers.
Bonus points	Compass members, lapsed or active, on a specific booking with a real deadline.	Non-members (they have no account to post to; invite them to enroll instead).	The strongest lever we have: CMP-003 at 4.3 ROI, CMP-009 at 8.5.
Free night	Any audience, on named unsold departures.	Open-ended or sitewide use.	Reads as generous without teaching customers to wait for a sale; CMP-011 cleared February inventory at 3.4 ROI.
Urgency	A single factual statement of a deadline ("book by October 31") on any asset.	Countdown timers, reminder sends within 72 hours of a deadline, and "last chance" language, for Compass audiences.	The countdown cell in CMP-003 converted worst and produced the most unsubscribes.
No offer	Any audience. The default for category	Nothing; it is never wrong to sell on curation and an honest price.	CMP-012's launch phase ran without an offer.

	launches and organic content.		
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Calls to action

We use four, written exactly this way, sentence case, no punctuation.

Call to action	When
Book now	Matched and retargeting audiences with clear intent; paid search; direct.
See deals	Prospecting placements and category collections where the reader is choosing among options.
Plan your escape	Lapsed and active Compass members, warm escapes, and email generally. Our signature call to action.
Claim offer	Percent-off or free-night offers to non-member audiences only. Not for Compass members.

Format specs by channel

Channel	Formats	Copy limits
Paid social	Static 1:1 (1080 × 1080) and 4:5 (1080 × 1350); vertical video 9:16, 6 to 15 seconds, captions burned in. Image text under 20 percent of the frame.	Primary text 125 characters, headline 40, one call to action.
Paid search	Responsive text ads.	Headlines 30 characters, descriptions 90, price frame in the first description.
Email	600 px wide, single column, live text over images, dark-mode tested.	Subject line under 45 characters, preheader under 90, one idea and one call to action per send, disclaimer in the footer.
Organic	Destination hero 1600 × 900; page body 120 to 200 words; five highlights of 2 to 6 words.	No superlatives; season stated honestly.
Direct	Home-page banner 1440 × 480 and 750 × 600 mobile; account-page offer card 600 × 300.	Headline 50 characters, one call to action, price frame on the banner.
Affiliate	Partner-native formats.	We supply the price frame, disclaimers and the banned-phrase list.

Accessibility

Every image carries alt text that describes what is shown ("a couple reading on a terrace above a calm bay in St. Lucia"), never the campaign name. Text over images meets a 4.5:1 contrast ratio and is also present as live text or alt text so screen readers and dark-mode clients can read it. Video carries burned-in captions and a transcript where the channel allows one. Calls to action are buttons with a text label, never image-only. Email uses a single column, a minimum 16 px body size and a logical reading order. Color is never the only carrier of meaning, including on price and deadline elements. Motion in video and animated formats avoids rapid flashing, and any animation on site respects the reader's reduced-motion setting.